

## Statistics for the SDGs - global indicators



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| <b>Name of the indicator</b>        | <b>15.4.2 Mountain Green Cover Index</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Sustainable Development Goal</b> | Goal 15. Life on land                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Target</b>                       | 15.4 By 2030, ensure the conservation of mountain ecosystems, including their biodiversity, in order to enhance their capacity to provide benefits that are essential for sustainable development                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Definition</b>                   | The percentage ratio of green vegetation in mountain areas - i.e. forest, grassland, shrubland, pasture land, crop land, etc. to mountain area.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Unit</b>                         | percent [%]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Available dimensions</b>         | total, Kapos class                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Methodological explanations</b>  | <p>Mountains are defined according to the UNEP-WCMC classification that identifies them according to altitude, slope and local elevation range as described by Kapos et al. 2000:</p> <p>Class 1: elevation &gt; 4,500 meters<br/> Class 2: elevation 3,500-4,500 meters<br/> Class 3: elevation 2,500 - 3,500 meters<br/> Class 4: elevation 1,500 -2,500 meters and slope &gt; 2<br/> Class 5: elevation 1,000 - 1,500 meters and slope &gt; 5 or local elevation range (LER 7 kilometer radius) &gt; 300 meters<br/> Class 6: elevation 300 - 1,000 meters and local elevation range (7 kilometer radius) &gt; 300 meters</p> |
| <b>Data source</b>                  | Head Office of Geodesy and Cartography                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Data availability</b>            | Annual data; since 2019                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Notes</b>                        | Mountains classification described in: Kapos V. Developing a map of the world's mountain forests., w M.Price i N.Butt (EDS.) Forests in sustainable mountain development: a state of knowledge report for 2000. Wallingford: CAB International.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Data updated on</b>              | 21-04-2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Metadata updated on</b>          | 05-06-2020                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |